

PHASE 1 · REVISION

Our response to your revision request of 11 September: the style guide, six fully laid-out sample pages, ten specimen entries for A Register of Colors, the page map updated to 288 pages, and the front-matter text revised to match your decisions. Everything here builds on the Phase 1 Blueprint and is for your review; nothing is print-ready.

IN THIS DELIVERY

	FILE	WHAT IT IS
1	THE-WORLD-style-guide.pdf	Type and licenses, grid and margins, line weights, flags, maps, illustrations, captions, data formats, palette, cover direction.
2	THE-WORLD-sample-country-pages.pdf	Italy, Japan, United States, Brazil, Egypt and Australia on one page system, on simulated cream stock. A white "as printed" version is included.
3	THE-WORLD-spread-preview.pdf	Two country pages facing each other, to judge the binding margin. Still one country per page.
4	THE-WORLD-color-register-10-specimens.pdf	Ten specimen entries, covering the hardest flags, for approval before the other 185 are written.
5	THE-WORLD-color-register-density-test (3 files)	All 195 entries laid out on the real register pages to test whether four pages hold them.
6	Page map	The Blueprint page map updated with every settled decision: 288 pages, 18 signatures, for your approval.
7	Front-matter text revisions	Epigraph, Melville on the Departure page, copyright note, and the three essay paragraphs that the decisions changed.
8	Source package	Vector maps, flags and illustrations (SVG), fonts with their licenses, page templates (HTML/CSS) and the data table with sources. See the note on InDesign below.

About the source files. The final book is planned in InDesign. This revision was built without InDesign, so we are not supplying .indd or .idml files: we could not open and check them, and a file nobody has checked is not a real source. Instead you have the parts InDesign uses directly: every map, flag and illustration as a true vector SVG, the fonts, and a grid specified in millimetres frame by frame, ready for the InDesign template in the layout phase.

Already applied from the Decisions Log: five facts on every page; no country experience on the page; illustration rule (landmark first, officially designated animal named in a second sentence, nothing invented); flag dots in reading order; register cut to four pages, in plain language; 2025 reference year; metric first; American English; UN treatment of borders, with short notes.

DECISIONS WE NEED FROM YOU

QUESTION	OUR RECOMMENDATION
1 Flag dots in a black-only interior. Your example in the Blueprint shows the dots in color, but the interior is specified in black only, and a black dot cannot show a color.	Outline dots with the color name beneath (used on the samples). Printed color dots would mean four-color printing on every country page.
2 Name line when the own-language name is English (United States, Australia and others).	Show the formal name (<i>Commonwealth of Australia</i>), so the line is never empty and never repeats the title.
3 Transliteration style under non-Latin names: standard or spoken form (<i>Misr</i> or <i>Masr</i>), with or without diacritics.	The standard form of the official language, without diacritics. All non-Latin names then go to a native reader.
4 Brazil illustration. Christ the Redeemer, shown in your reference images, is licensed by the Archdiocese of Rio de Janeiro for commercial products.	Sugarloaf Mountain (on the sample), unless you want us to ask about a license.
5 Color register length. Four pages hold all 195 entries only at 8.5 pt with a strict length per entry (about 70 / 125 / 215 characters for simple / medium / complex flags). At 9 pt the register needs six pages.	Keep four pages at 8.5 pt with the length budget, and shorten Belize, Nepal and South Africa accordingly; or, if you prefer 9 pt, give the register six pages (the two notes pages plus one more spread).
6 The ten register specimens: pattern, wording and choice of flags.	Approve the pattern; any wording change you make becomes the rule for all 195.
7 Flags carrying religious inscriptions (Saudi Arabia, Iraq and others): an outline invites the reader to color the inscription.	Keep the inscription pre-printed rather than left open to color, and treat these entries with particular care.
8 Page map at 288 pages: the Blueprint structure plus bucket lists, Top Five, Favorite Memory and the expanded ledger, with two notes pages before the colophon.	Approve; Part III now opens on p. 28 so each continent opener is a true spread.
9 Names and grouping: UN short names (Türkiye, Czechia, Côte d'Ivoire), Holy See naming, UN M49 continents.	As set out on page 3 of the page map.
10 Cover: navy or Old Pink cloth; foil on the back cover (in your first brief, not in RFQ v2).	Navy with gold on front and spine; quote back-cover foil only if you want it.
11 Photo frame. The Blueprint sizes it for a 9 × 13 cm print, but a whole print (89 × 127 mm) does not fit on the page beside everything else.	A 90 × 64 mm frame that takes a 9 × 13 print cut in half, or an instant mini print, as on the samples.
12 Population source: one international source for all 195 countries (UN World Population Prospects) instead of national figures.	UN source: comparable everywhere, available for 2025, and covering the Holy See and Palestine.

WHAT WE STILL NEED FOR PRODUCTION

- Your approval of the decisions on page 2, of the page map and of the front-matter text revisions.
- Main sales market, and whether part of the run should go straight to a US fulfillment company (this has to be priced in the quotation).
- Exact address of the fulfillment warehouse in the Netherlands.
- Three comparable quotations on RFQ v2, then the choice between offset and print on demand.
- From the chosen printer: case and spine template, a bound blank dummy in the final materials (it settles the spine, estimated near 25 mm, and the weight, estimated 1.1–1.2 kg), cloth and foil swatches, and minimum foil line sizes.
- A native reader for roughly fifty non-Latin country names.

INVESTMENT ESTIMATE · THE FIGURES TO COLLECT

You asked for help estimating the investment. We will not quote a total before the inputs exist; this is the worksheet we will fill in together. Every figure will be marked as a quotation or an estimate, with its source.

COST LINE	WHERE THE FIGURE COMES FROM
1 Printing and binding at 1,000 / 1,500 / 3,000 copies	Printer quotations (RFQ v2)
2 Proofs, dummy, make-ready, foil dies, options (endpapers, head and tail bands, ribbon)	Printer quotations
3 Freight to the Netherlands; optional split delivery to the US	Quoted separately by printer or forwarder
4 Import duties and taxes	To verify with your customs/tax professional
5 Storage, pick and pack, shipping to the end customer	Fulfillment company rate card
6 Remaining production: illustration, text and data for 189 countries, register, layout, cover, prepress	Our quotation for the next phases
7 Native-reader proofing; final proofreading	Quotation
8 ISBN and barcode; marketplace or retailer fees and margins	Your registration agency; channel terms
9 Marketing and launch	Your budget; outside this order

NEXT PHASES TO QUOTE

Not part of the current order: illustration production. The Blueprint counts 585 drawings (195 vignettes, 195 maps, 195 flags); the samples show that maps and flags can be produced from verified geographic and flag data, so the hand-drawn work is mainly the 195 vignettes; research, text and verified data for the remaining 189 countries and their maps and flags; the other 185 register entries; continent openers, bucket lists and closing spreads; layout in InDesign by continent; cover and foil artwork on the printer's template; final production and liaison with the printer. Publishing and marketing support can be quoted separately if you want it.